

During this time your baby is evolving into a recognizably human baby. Development is rapid, and by the end of the first trimester, all the major organs and body systems are in place.

7 WEEKS Though you still cannot feel the baby inside you, the heart can be seen beating on an ultrasound now.



Baby watch

📏 1 1/2 in (1.6 cm) ⚖️ 1/2 oz (1 g)

Major organs are now being formed; the digestive system and bowel are taking shape and your baby's lungs have begun to develop. The head is proportionally larger than the rest of the body. The embryo is covered in a thin layer of skin and the fingers and toes are primitive. The placenta is growing stronger and will be ready to take over in a few weeks.

Mom matters

Your uterus is gradually expanding, and you may find that your waistline is thicker. Your breasts will be heavier and may feel tender as they start to adapt for breast-feeding. Hormonal surges can also bring skin changes, and you may find you suddenly get acne, or that your skin dries out.



This week...

- » Start practicing Kegel exercises.
- » Be attentive to kitchen hygiene since you are more vulnerable to food poisoning in pregnancy.
- » Be aware of toxoplasmosis, which can be found in cat feces, undercooked meat, and contaminated soil.
- » Be safe when using cleaning products—wear protective gloves and open windows so that you don't inhale fumes.

8 WEEKS As your body adapts to the hormonal changes of pregnancy, you may get sudden mood swings.



Baby watch

📏 1 3/8 in (2.3 cm) ⚖️ 1/4 oz (2 g)

Your baby is the size of a large grape, and a tiny nose is now visible. The limbs resemble paddles, though the fingers and toes have not formed yet. The eyes are now larger and darkening with pigment. The yolk sac starts to shrink as the embryo increasingly gets oxygen and nutrients from you.

Mom matters

These first weeks are commonly marked by nausea, complete exhaustion, and mood swings. These are caused by hormonal and physiological changes that support your growing baby. Frequent trips to the bathroom are due to the increased production of urine by certain hormones and the growing uterus putting pressure on your bladder. Many women also have strange food cravings, or develop strong aversions to some foods.



This week...

- » Make an appointment with the dentist (you should already be going twice a year) to check your gum health since gums soften and bleed in pregnancy.
- » If your breasts feel fuller, get your bust measured by an experienced fitter and buy a supportive maternity bra.
- » Get a flu shot at any time to protect your baby and yourself.

9 WEEKS Your tiny baby is starting to move around, though you won't yet be able to feel this exciting action.



Baby watch

📏 1 1/4 in (3 cm) ⚖️ 1/8 oz (4 g)

Now the size of a prune, your baby continues to develop. The webbed fingers start to separate and tiny toes are emerging. Early facial features are in place. Soft cartilage makes up the skeleton, which will later harden into bone. The sex organs and external genitalia begin to form, though it's not possible to tell your baby's sex yet. Buds from the bladder connect with tissue cells that will eventually form the kidneys.

Mom matters

Your respiratory system adapts rapidly to help your body meet the demands of pregnancy. The ribs expand and the diaphragm moves up, enabling the lungs to take in more air, increasing oxygen absorption. You may feel the heat since the blood supply to the skin increases; to counter this, blood vessels dilate, dispersing heat and controlling your blood pressure.



This week...

- » Start to budget for when the baby arrives.
- » Keep up with or start some gentle exercise—the more fit you keep yourself, the easier labor and delivery will be.